TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Recommend a Better Way of Doing a Task at Work

Recommend | OREO | Make a Recommendation

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Find out what matters most, recommend one change to the way a task is done now, say why it is better than now, and say how to start.

WHO You work in sales with Kumar. Customers phone in about 120 orders a month, and whoever answers the phone writes the order down.

SITUATION Now orders are written on any piece of paper, and about 6 a month go out wrong: a wrong address or the wrong number of items. Each one costs about RM50 to send again, so about RM300 a month.

NEED Mr. Tan wants fewer wrong deliveries, with no big cost. He asks you: 'What should we change, and how do we start?'

GOAL Recommend one change to the way we take phone orders, say why it is better than now, and say how to start.

Now

- Orders written on any piece of paper
- About 6 of 120 orders a month go out wrong
- About RM50 to send each one again · about RM300 a month

The idea: an order pad

- Five boxes: name, item, how many, address, date
- Read the order back before you hang up: about 1 minute more
- Ace Print: 20 pads in 3 days · RM60 in total

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Mr. Tan asks: “Six phone orders a month go out wrong, and it costs us money. What should we change?” Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Kumar’s answer. Mark where each part starts.

We need fewer wrong deliveries, so I'd recommend an order pad next to every phone, instead of writing orders on any paper. The main reason is the five boxes: name, item, how many, address and date. Nobody forgets a box, and we read the order back before we hang up. Now about six of our 120 orders a month go out wrong, at RM50 each to send again. Reading back takes a minute longer, but that’s better than paying RM300 a month. So overall, we should try the pads for two weeks. I can order 20 from Ace Print today, for RM60, and if the mistakes go down, we'll keep them.

O NEED · CHANGE

R REASON

E COMPARE WITH NOW

O RECOMMEND AGAIN · FIRST STEP

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Ali recommends a better way to save work files. Order: Recommend → Reason → Compare → Recommend again.

- [ ] We can't lose customer files again, so I'd recommend one shared folder for all our work files.
- [ ] So I think we should start with the accounts team on Monday. I can set it up for them in an hour.
- [ ] The main reason is that the shared folder is copied every night, so nothing is lost if a laptop breaks.
- [ ] Saving on your own laptop is quicker, but last month one broke and we lost a customer list.

Write the letter: **O** = Need · change · **R** = Reason · **E** = Compare with now · **O** = Recommend again · first step

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SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

ASK ABOUT THE NEED

- [ ] What matters most to you?
- [ ] When is a good time to start?
- [ ] Who could help with it?

RECOMMEND A CHANGE

- [ ] We need …, so I'd recommend …
- [ ] I think we should … instead of …
- [ ] We could try …
- [ ] It may be better to …

COMPARE WITH NOW

- [ ] Now it takes …; with … it takes …
- [ ] It's faster / safer than …
- [ ] It takes a bit longer, but …
- [ ] It costs …, but it saves …

SAY HOW TO START

- [ ] First, I can …
- [ ] We could start on …
- [ ] Let's try it for two weeks.
- [ ] If it works, we'll …

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. Each wrong order costs about RM50 to send again. [but / so / because] Six wrong orders cost us about RM300 a month.

2. Reading the order back takes a minute longer. [but / because / For example,] It's much better than sending the parcel again.

3. I'd recommend an order pad. [because / so / but] It has the same five boxes for every order.

4. The mistakes go down in two weeks. [For example, / but / If …] We'll keep the pads.

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. About six orders a month _____ out wrong. (A fact about now)
   ○ goes ○ going ○ go
2. Reading the order back is _____ than sending the parcel again. (Comparing with now)
   ○ cheaper ○ cheapest ○ more cheap
3. If we use the pads, we _____ fewer wrong deliveries. (What will happen)
   ○ will has ○ will have ○ will having
4. I think we _____ the pads for two weeks. (Recommending)
   ○ should trying ○ should to try ○ should try

SLIDE 09

should / could · -er than · if … will

To recommend a change: say what we should or could do, compare it with now, and say what will happen if we try it.

I think we **should** try the order pad. We **could** start next week.

Reading the order back is **slower**, but it's **safer than** a note on any paper.

Now we **write** orders on any paper. With the pad, we'**ll fill in** the same five boxes every time.

If the wrong deliveries go down, we'**ll save** money every month.

SLIDE 10

Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

O NEED · CHANGE

We need …, so I'd recommend … instead of …

R REASON

The main reason is …

E COMPARE WITH NOW

Now … . With …, it's faster / safer than now.

O RECOMMEND AGAIN · FIRST STEP

So overall, we should … . First, I can … . If it works, we'll …

SLIDE 11 Make a Recommendation

The speaker asks what matters most, recommends one change to the way a job is done now and says how to start. The listener writes a note: the change, why it is better than now, and the first step.

1. Round 1 (3:00): say your card number. Ask what matters most. Recommend one change, then say how to start.
2. Listener: need when asked; 'Who starts, and when?'; then your news. Fill the note. Empty line? Ask 'How is it better?'
3. Round 2 (2:00): listeners move one seat. Same card, new listener, shorter: need, change, better than now, first step.
4. Round 3 (1:00), frames closed, no asking: 'We need …, so …'. Card only, new listener. Then swap roles: rounds 1–3 again.

Card 1 · The monthly stock count

Card 2 · Customer emails

Card 3 · Paying suppliers

Card 4 · The delivery van

Listener's note

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Card · asked first?			
The change			
Better than now because			
First step: who, when			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Mr. Tan asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. How much will it cost?
2. When can we start?
3. How will we know if it works?

Start with: **It will cost about … · The pads take … to print, so we can start … · We'll count … . If …, we'll …**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

A friend's mother queues at the post office for about 40 minutes every month to pay three bills, and last month she paid one late. Recommend a better way (for example, an e-wallet app on her phone), say why it is better than now, and how she can start.

She needs …, so I'd recommend … · Now it takes …; with … it takes … · It's … than …, but … · First, you could … on …

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Names the need and recommends one change to the current way.
- [ ] Says why the change is better and compares it with now.
- [ ] Says how to start: who does what first, and when.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Need and change	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Comparing with now	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
How to start	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · The monthly stock count

You are Siti. When asked, say what matters most: a count that is right; we order new stock from it. News, only after the first step: Mei Ling is on leave in the last week of the month. Fill the note.

Card 2 · Customer emails

You are Mr. Tan. When asked, say what matters most: no customer email waits when someone is on leave. News, only after the first step: Ali has time only on Thursday afternoon. Fill the note.

Card 3 · Paying suppliers

You are Mei Ling. When asked, say what matters most: we pay every supplier on time. News, only after the first step: you are busy with the expense claims until the 25th. Fill the note.

Card 4 · The delivery van

You are Kumar. When asked, say what matters most: customers get their parcels before lunch. News, only after the first step: you are at a customer's office in Melaka until Wednesday. Fill the note.

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · The monthly stock count

Idea: in the last week of the month, count one shelf a day (40 minutes), Monday to Friday. Now: you and Mei Ling count all 5 shelves on the last Friday: 4 hours, and nobody answers the phone. Tired people count 10 items wrong.

Card 2 · Customer emails

Now: customer emails go only to Kumar's inbox, and some wait 2 days for an answer. Ali can set up a shared inbox in one afternoon, at no cost. Idea: one shared sales inbox that 3 people can open, and a rule: reply within 4 hours.

Card 3 · Paying suppliers

Last month 2 invoices were paid late: RM80 in late fees. Idea: one list of all invoices with the due date, checked every Monday. Now: invoices come by post and email, kept in 3 places. The list takes about 2 hours to set up.

Card 4 · The delivery van

Saves: about 1 hour of driving and RM10 of petrol a day. Now: the driver plans his route every morning (40 minutes) and often crosses JB twice. Idea: Kumar sends him the delivery list at 5 p.m. the day before, sorted by area.